Ritabrata Chakraborty

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Education

University of Pennsylvania — **Pennsylvania, USA**
*M.S.E. in Robotics, **GPA: –/4*** — *Aug '26 – May '28*

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani (BITS Pilani) — **Rajasthan, India**
*B.E. in Mechanical Engineering — Minor in Data Science, **CGPA: 8.57/10*** — *Oct '22 – May '26*

- **Institute Merit-cum-Need Scholarship** — Consecutive Recipient (Top 8% of Students)

Publications & Peer Reviews

Journal Publications

- **R. Chakraborty** and K. Kishore, ***"Navigating Without Satellites: A Critical Survey of GNSS-Denied UAV Navigation."*** Submitted to **IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence (T-AI)**, 2026.
- **R. Chakraborty** and K. Kishore, ***"Multi-Critic Off-Policy Reinforcement Learning for Quadrotor Velocity Control in Unknown Indoor Environments."*** Manuscript in preparation for **IEEE Transactions on Artificial Intelligence (T-AI)**, 2026.

Conference Publications

- Y. Wang, H. He, Y. Cao, J. Liang, **R. Chakraborty**, and G. Sartoretti, ***"CogniPlan: Uncertainty-Guided Path Planning with Conditional Generative Layout Prediction."*** Accepted at **Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)**, 2025; published in **Proceedings of Machine Learning Research (PMLR)**.
- **R. Chakraborty**, T. Mian, and P. Kundu, ***"An Efficient Approach for Synthetic Data Generation and Fault Diagnosis for Rotating Machinery."*** Accepted at **Prognostics and System Health Management Conference (PHM)**, 2025; published in **IET Conference Proceedings**.
- K. Kishore and **R. Chakraborty**, ***"Path Planning of Low-Altitude UAV for Tree Canopy Tracking and Orchard Monitoring."*** Publication awaiting intellectual property clearance, 2025.

Peer Reviews

- ***"GS-SDE: 3D Gaussian Splatting-based Adaptive Scene Modeling in Semi-Dynamic Environments."*** Peer review completed for **IEEE Transactions on Automation Science and Engineering (T-ASE)**, 2026.
- ***"Limits of Wearable Gait Analysis for Age Classification in Young Adults: Anthropometry Over Age."*** Peer review completed for **IEEE India Council International Subsections Conference (INDISCON)**, 2026.

Experience – Robotics & Computer Vision

Multi-Critic Decomposition for Autonomous Indoor Navigation

Supervisor: Dr. Kaushal Kishore, Principal Scientist, CSIR-CEERI — *Jan '26 – May '26*

- Integrated three specialized critics for forward progress, lateral avoidance, and angular alignment with distinct reward signals.
- Deployed multi-critic TD3 with prioritized replay achieving 94.2% success rate and 22% lower collision rate versus baseline.

ML Intern | Uber (AI Solutions)

Supervisor: Mr. Siddarth Malreddy, Tech Lead Manager & Mr. Ishan Nigam, Senior ML Engineer, Uber — *Jul '25 – Dec '25*

- Augmented uLabel with object tracking for automated RGB/IR video annotation, reducing manual effort.
- Applied XGBoost anomaly detection (mAP50: 75%) to flag perturbed bboxes in human-in-the-loop tracking validation.

Design and Development of Smart Automated Field Hockey Ball Launcher

Supervisor: Dr. Mani Shankar Dasgupta, Associate Professor, BITS Pilani — *Apr '24 – Oct '25*

Physics-Based Launcher Mechanical Design and FEM Analysis

- Fabricated programmable launcher achieving 150 km/h using CFRP composite and stainless steel components.
- Performed FEM analysis and CAD using Fusion 360, achieving safety factor 2.07 at 496 RPM.

Computer Vision Pipeline for 3D Trajectory Reconstruction and Shot Classification

- Devised 3D ball localization from monocular videos using diameter-based depth and PnLCalib (0.76m RMSE).
- Constructed TCN-attention classifier fusing trajectory and statistical features, achieving 96.4% classification accuracy.

Uncertainty-Guided Path Planning via Conditional Layout Prediction

Supervisor: Dr. Guillaume Sartoretti, Assistant Professor, MARMoT Lab, NUS — *Mar '25 – Aug '25*

- Adapted multiple image-based exploration planners into ROS pipelines for evaluation in the CMU Exploration Environment.
- Supported the development and benchmarking of *CogniPlan*, achieving up to 17.7% shorter exploration paths and 3.9% improved navigation efficiency over state-of-the-art baselines across 100+ unseen maps.

Monocular Vision-Based UAV Navigation for Orchard Monitoring

Supervisor: Dr. Kaushal Kishore, Principal Scientist, CSIR-CEERI — *Jan '24 – Feb '25*

- Engineered a UAV-based orchard monitoring system using YOLOv11 (Box mAP50: 95.5%, Mask mAP50: 96.5%).
- Implemented B-spline trajectory logic and coded custom yaw-roll controller to minimize drift under wind.

Experience – Generative AI & Predictive Maintenance

Synthetic Data Generation for Bearing Fault Diagnosis Under Data Scarcity
Supervisor: Dr. Pradeep Kundu, Assistant Professor, KU Leuven — *Sep '24 – May '26*

Auxiliary Classifier WGAN-GP for Time-Series Sensor Data Generation

- Built ACWGAN-GP with TCN discriminator for minority fault class augmentation reaching ∼100% classification accuracy.
- Assessed synthetic data using PCC, Cosine Similarity, MMD, and KL Divergence on FFT spectra.

Physics-Informed Generative Modeling for Bearing Fault Diagnosis Under Data Scarcity

- Formulated physics-informed cVAE-GAN and cVQ-GAN frameworks isolating latent-space effects in CWT scalogram synthesis.
- Validated LiteFormer classification gains across Density, Coverage, and CMMD metrics.

Projects

Autonomous Drone Navigation | MathWorks Global Student Drone Challenge 2025 — *Mar '25 – Apr '25*

- Designed vision-based control for Parrot Mambo drone using masking, ray-tracing, and closed-loop yaw control.
- Optimized speed control and zone-based auto-landing to reduce track completion time.

ExoMy Rover Navigation and UR3 Arm Motion Planning | ERC 2023 Remote — *Apr '23 – Sep '23*

- Navigated ExoMy rover using ArUco detection, Ackermann steering, and spot turns for autonomous hazard avoidance.
- Calibrated UR3 arm with MoveIt and OMPL planner for collision-free manipulation (98% success).

Awards & Achievements

Finalist — Meta PyTorch OpenEnv Hackathon (India) — *Apr '26*
3rd Place — MathWorks Global Drone Student Challenge 2025 — *Mar '25*
Finalist — ISRO Immersion Challenge (AI for Space & Geospatial Innovation) — *Jul '24*
Top 15 Overall, Top 5 in College — American Express Campus Challenge 2024 — *Jul '24*
5th Place & Best Maintenance Award — European Rover Challenge 2023 (Remote Finals) — *Sep '23*

Teaching

Teaching Assistant
CS F320: Foundations of Data Science, BITS Pilani — *Jan '26 – May '26*
ME F218: Advanced Mechanics of Solids, BITS Pilani — *Jan '25 – May '25*
ME F216: Materials Science and Engineering, BITS Pilani — *Sep '24 – Dec '24*

- Assisted 100+ students in labs and tutorials, clarifying concepts and linking theory to practical applications.
- Analyzed assignments and facilitated faculty in delivering high-impact teaching sessions.

Leadership & Volunteering

Deputy Director of Academic Programming
Graduate and Professional Student Assembly (GAPSA), University of Pennsylvania — *Aug '26 – Present*

Vice-President
South Asian Association (Rangoli), University of Pennsylvania — *Aug '26 – Present*

President & Secretary
Mechanical Engineering Association (MEA), BITS Pilani — *Jun '24 – May '26*

- Coordinated 10+ events and career sessions for 300+ students, facilitating technical exposure and alumni interaction.
- Managed production of 500+ merchandise items and led outreach, boosting student participation by 20%.

President & Tech Fest Coordinator
Indian Society of Heating, Refrigerating, and Air Conditioning Engineers (ISHRAE), BITS Pilani — *Oct '24 – Jul '25*

- Led a team of 25+ members to organize 4+ technical workshops with HVAC industry experts.
- Hosted 3 competitions and networking events, engaging 200+ students in HVAC innovation and awareness.

Project Manager
Tinkerer's Lab (TL), BITS Pilani — *May '24 – Jul '25*

- Supervised 5 interdisciplinary robotics teams (30+ members) on Micromouse and Hexapod projects.
- Oversaw lab resources, conducted weekly reviews, and mentored 50+ students in hands-on technical skills.

Technical Skills & Coursework

Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Foundations of Data Science, Applied Statistical Methods, Linear Algebra, Computer Programming, Engineering Optimization, Differential Equations, Design of Machine Elements, Digital Twins

Programming Languages: Python, C++, C, Shell (Linux)

Robotics & Simulation: ROS (with Gazebo, Rviz), MAVROS, Navigation Stack, MoveIt, AirSim, Unity, Unreal Engine, MATLAB, Simulink, QGIS

Machine Learning: PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-Learn, OpenCV, Open3D, Matplotlib, Weights & Biases (W&B)

Hardware & Embedded Systems: NVIDIA Jetson (Nano, Orin), Raspberry Pi, Arduino, IMUs, Stereo Camera, 3D LiDAR

CAD & Mechanical Simulation: ANSYS Mechanical, SolidWorks, Fusion 360